PRIORITY 14 OF 33 · SCORE 3.2

Army Corps of Engineers

The Corps spends almost entirely through construction and dredging contracts, many of them small business set-aside, and it ramps up sharply after disasters. That makes it a near copy of the DoD contractor screen at a smaller scale. Bid rigging among a few regional dredging and construction firms is the second pattern.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

USACE-1	Set-aside fronts by district. **First prototype.**
USACE-2	Bid rotation in dredging and other published bids.
USACE-3	Change-order growth versus peer projects.

EXPOSURE

- $28B in outlays and $77B in budgetary resources in FY2026, boosted by infrastructure and disaster supplemental money.
- Set-aside fronts, bid rigging and inflated change orders are recurring case types for the Army CID and DOJ's Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **FPDS / USAspending:** awards, set-aside type, number of offers, modifications.
- **SAM.gov** entities and exclusions; SBA certification lists.
- **DOJ and Army CID** case releases.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **Front companies:** the DoD set-aside screen (see DoD) applied to Corps districts.
2. **Collusion signals:** few bidders per award, stable win rotation, and shared officers among "competitors" in a district.
3. **Change-order growth:** contracts whose value grows far beyond award compared with peer projects.

FIRST PROTOTYPE

Run the DoD contractor integrity screen on Corps awards and add a district-level bid rotation view.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
● Pending

Phase 1 window
Weeks 9–11
Jan 11, 2027 to Jan 29, 2027

Workstream
Shared screens

FY2026 outlays
$28.5B · budget rank 18

Leads go to
Army CID MPFU, PCSF

WHY PRIORITY 14

Exposure	●●○○○
Public data	●●●●○
SBA method fit	●●●●○
Actionability	●●●○○

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 11

Run the contractor screen by Corps district; add a bid rotation view using the Corps' dredging contract history where bids are published, and offers received from FPDS elsewhere; compare change-order growth with peer projects. Deliver district-level results and memo in week 11.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF USACE

A named contact to receive leads, and a short review of the Phase 1 results to agree which internal records would confirm or rule them out.

LIMITS

Bid amounts for losing offers are not in FPDS; collusion tests rely on number of offers and win patterns.

SOURCES

- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)
- DOJ Procurement Collusion Strike Force

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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